

CUSTOMER & MVP BLUEPRINT

AI-Powered Career Platform for India's Students & Fresh Graduates

Derived from Startup Validation Report · June 2026 · Strategic Validation Unit

\$7.5B	57%	28.7%	8.3/10	■ GO
India EdTech TAM	Grads Not Job-Ready	Market CAGR	Viability Score	Verdict

The AI Career Platform targets India's structural employability crisis: 57% of graduates are not job-ready despite 2.3 crore open vacancies. This blueprint translates validated market data into a clear ICP, buyer personas, prioritised MVP scope, pricing hypothesis, and a 30-day action plan. Verdict: **Strong Demand Signal** — build the AI career path finder + resume builder as your Day-1 MVP.

01 IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE (ICP)

Three distinct segments — each with different needs and monetisation paths

Segment	Profile	Location	Willingness to Pay	Value Prop
■ College Student (Primary)	Age 16–22 2nd–3rd year STEM/Commerce Tier 1–3 college	Metros + Tier-2 (Pune, Jaipur, Lucknow, Ahmedabad)	Low-Medium ■199–499/month	Free AI career path + resume → premium mock interviews
■ Fresh Graduate / Career Changer (Secondary)	Age 22–27 0–3 yrs exp Pivoting roles/degrees Higher digital savvy	Urban-first: Metro + Tier-1	Medium-High ■999–2,999/month or ■5K–15K cohort	Outcome-based upskilling + AI resume + employer-matched referrals
■ Educational Institution (B2B2C)	Tier 2/3 engineering & management colleges 500–5K students No placement SaaS	Pan-India, underserved colleges	■50K–■3L/year per institution	White-label placement dashboard + bulk assessments + employer network

02 BUYER PERSONAS

Humanised profiles of your two primary B2C customers

PRIYA SHARMA

2nd Year B.Tech |
Age 20 | Bhopal
(Tier-2)

"I have good grades but no idea what career to choose. My college placement cell only helps final years."

Goals: First internship before 3rd year · Standout resume · Learn right skills for dream role

Frustrations: Overwhelmed by YouTube advice · Internshala applications unanswered · Can't afford ■30K courses

Trigger: Placement season · Friend got internship · LinkedIn post about skills

Platforms: Instagram · YouTube · WhatsApp · LinkedIn (new) · Internshala

Budget: ■500–1,000/month discretionary (parent-funded)

ARJUN MEHTA

Fresh BBA
Graduate / Career
Switcher | Age 24 |
Mumbai (Metro)

"I graduated 8 months ago. Applied to 100+ jobs, got 3 interviews. Something is clearly missing."

Goals: Land marketing/product role at startup · Fill skill gaps (data, digital mktg) · Rebuild resume around outcomes

Frustrations: Naukri resume gets zero calls · Generic courses don't lead to jobs · Career coach = ■3K–5K/session

Trigger: Peer gets hired · LinkedIn rejection email · Article about skill gaps

Platforms: LinkedIn · Naukri · YouTube · Reddit (r/india) · Twitter/X

Budget: ■15,000/month (part-time income)

03 TOP 10 CUSTOMER PAIN POINTS

Ranked by severity and frequency of occurrence

#	Pain Point	Severity	Freq	Current Workaround
1	No structured career guidance — students don't know where to start	■ Critical	Very High	YouTube, social media, hope
2	Cannot write compelling, ATS-optimised resume	■ Critical	High	Free templates, seniors' advice
3	Internship applications go unanswered — no differentiator	■ High	Very High	Bulk apply on Internshala/LinkedIn
4	Skills from college mismatched with industry needs	■ High	Constant	Self-learn via YouTube/Udemy ad hoc
5	Career counselling expensive or unavailable (Tier 2/3)	■ High	High	Word of mouth, free webinars, family
6	No personalised feedback on applications or skills	■ Medium	High	Nothing — they don't know what's wrong
7	Lack of professional network for referrals	■ Medium	High	LinkedIn (unfamiliar), alumni (limited)
8	Anxiety about AI replacing jobs — no clarity on future paths	■ Medium	Growing	Social media speculation
9	Skills gap between course certificates & employer expectations	■ Medium	High	More certificates (diminishing returns)
10	Expensive courses don't guarantee placement outcomes	■ Medium	Medium	Free YouTube courses

04 CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP

From first touch to brand advocacy

AWARE	CONSIDER	SIGN UP	ENGAGE	CONVERT	ADVOCATE
- Instagram/YouTube reel - Friend referral - College notice board - Google: 'career guidance India'	- Visits landing page - Reads success stories - Tries free AI quiz - Compares with Internshala	- Frictionless Google sign-in 3-min AI career assessment - Personalised career roadmap - First resume draft generated	- Follows learning modules - Applies to AI-matched internships - Gets resume score + tips - Joins peer community	- Unlocks mock interviews - Premium courses access - Priority job applications 1:1 mentor session	- Shares success story - Refers 3 friends (free month) - Provides testimonial - Returns for next career stage

05 OBJECTIONS & BUYING TRIGGERS

What blocks conversion — and what unlocks it

Objection	Segment	Counter-Strategy
"Why pay when YouTube/LinkedIn is free?"	Students	Show personalised AI guidance vs. unstructured browsing. Time-to-outcome comparison.
"I don't trust EdTech after BYJU's"	All	Outcome-first: free until results. Real student stories with verifiable outcomes.
"My college has a placement cell"	Students	Complement, don't compete. Show platform prepares students before the placement cell.
"Too expensive for a student"	B2C	Meaningful free tier. Institution-subsidised access. EMI / pay-after-placement options.
"We already use a vendor"	Institutions	Pilot cohort comparison. Show outcome data vs. incumbent. 3-month free institutional trial.

■ Placement Season

Students highly motivated 6–12 months before finals. Target Aug–Oct & Jan–Mar.

■ Peer Social Proof

Friend landing a job is #1 trigger. Build referral loops + success story sharing.

■ Resume Rejection

Failure creates 'pain moment' — users most open to investing in improvement tools.

■ College Endorsement

Institutional trust (MoU, placement cell) dramatically reduces sign-up resistance.

■ Free Value Experience

Users who try free AI resume builder and see instant value convert at high rates.

■ First Job/Internship Offer

Even one offer via platform creates immediate testimonial + referral cascade.

06 MVP RECOMMENDATION

What to build first, what to skip — and how to measure success

■ BUILD FIRST (Day 1 MVP)	■ DO NOT BUILD YET
AI Career Path Finder — aptitude + interest + market demand → personalised career roadmap	Full-blown LMS / course platform (high cost, slow build)
AI Resume Builder — ATS-optimised resume generation from simple inputs	Social network / community features (premature)
Job/Internship Feed — curated listings matched to user profile (aggregate Internshala/Naukri initially)	Vernacular support beyond Hindi (too early)
Employability Score — real-time score with specific improvement nudges	Employer-facing talent intelligence dashboard
Freemium Conversion Gate — mock interview & 1:1 mentoring behind paywall	Mobile app (web-first for faster iteration)

Success Metric	Target (Day 30)	Target (Month 3)
Beta Users Onboarded	200+ active users	2,000+ MAU
Resume Builds Completed	500+	5,000+
Job/Internship Applications Facilitated	100+	1,000+
NPS Score	50+ (promoter-majority)	60+
College MoUs in Pipeline	5 conversations / 2 LOIs	3 signed MoUs

Employer Partners	3 SME employers	15 employers
Referral Loop	Programme live / 50 tracked	20% of new users via referral

07 MoSCoW PRIORITISATION

Feature prioritisation for MVP build sprint

MUST HAVE	SHOULD HAVE	COULD HAVE	WON'T HAVE (V1)
- AI Career Path Finder (aptitude → career roadmap) - AI Resume Builder (ATS-optimised) - Job/Internship Feed (aggregated listings) - Employability Score Dashboard - Free tier + Freemium paywall (mock interview gate) - Google/email sign-in onboarding (<3 minutes)	- Personalised skill gap analysis & learning recommendations - Application tracker (status + AI tips to improve) - NPS + in-app feedback loop - College partnership onboarding flow (B2B2C) - Hindi language toggle - Referral programme (free premium month per 3 referrals)	- Live 1:1 mentor booking - Community / peer groups - Mock interview simulator (AI video) - Micro-internship marketplace (2–4 week projects) - Employer dashboard (post jobs, view candidates) - Vernacular support (regional languages beyond Hindi)	- Full LMS / course platform - Native mobile app (web-first) - Social network features - B2B enterprise HR tools - International market (SEA/MENA) — V2+ - AI video interview with real employers

08 PRICING HYPOTHESIS

Freemium B2C + B2B2C institutional + employer listings

Tier	Target	Price Point	Key Features	Revenue Mix
Free	All users	■0	AI career quiz, basic resume, 5 job applications/month	Acquisition layer
Premium (B2C)	Active students / graduates	■299–499/month ■2,499/year	Unlimited apps, mock interviews, skill courses, 1:1 mentor (1 session)	~40% of revenue
Outcome Cohort	Career changers	■5,000–15,000 (one-time)	Job-guarantee cohort, structured 8-week curriculum, placement support	~10% of revenue
Institutional (B2B2C)	Colleges & training centres	■50K–■3L/year	White-label dashboard, bulk assessments, employer network, placement analytics	~30% of revenue
Employer Listings	SMEs & startups	■2,000–15,000/listing	AI-matched candidate pools, branded job posts, campus recruitment	~20% of revenue

09 TOP 5 RISKS

Ranked by severity × probability — with mitigations

#	Risk	Severity	Probability	Mitigation
1	Competitive intensity from Internshala, LinkedIn, upGrad	HIGH	HIGH	AI-first integrated suite — no incumbent offers full stack. Community-led moat.
2	High User Acquisition Cost (CAC > LTV early)	HIGH	MEDIUM	B2B2C college partnerships as distribution. Referral loops. Content-led organic growth.
3	EdTech trust deficit (BYJU's effect)	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Outcome-first model. Free until results. Real, verifiable success stories.
4	AI accuracy & recommendation bias	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Human-in-loop fallback. Continuous fine-tuning. Transparent confidence scores.
5	Monetisation lag (students defer payment)	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Early B2B2C revenue anchors. Institutional contracts = predictable ARR.

10 30-DAY MVP ACTION PLAN

Week-by-week execution map with measurable KPIs

Week	Action	Owner	KPI
1–2	Lock MVP feature scope: AI path finder + resume builder + job feed	Founder	Feature list signed off
1–2	Book 5 college placement cell meetings (MoU conversations)	Founder	5 meetings booked
1–2	Identify & approach technical co-founder / AI product lead	Founder	3 candidates in conversation
3–4	Launch closed beta with 200 students from 3 colleges	Product	200 beta users onboarded
3–4	Implement NPS survey + weekly 30-min user interviews	Product	NPS baseline set
5–6	Ship Hindi language toggle for onboarding	Engineering	Language toggle live
5–6	Publish 10 outcome-focused student success stories	Marketing	10 stories live on site + social
7–8	Onboard 3 SME/startup employers for job listings	BD	3 employers posting live jobs
7–8	Launch referral programme (free premium month per 3 referrals)	Growth	Referral loop live + 50 tracked
9–10	Open institutional waitlist for B2B2C tier	Sales	50 institution leads captured
9–10	Apply to YC, Surge, Antler India accelerators	Founder	3 applications submitted
11–12	Analyse cohort data; iterate AI recommendation model	Data/AI	Model accuracy +10%
11–12	Prepare seed fundraising deck & financial model	Founder	Deck investor-ready

11 FOUNDER ACTION SHEET

Top 10 next actions — prioritised for maximum momentum

1	TODAY	Lock MVP feature scope to 4 core features: AI path finder, resume builder, job feed, employability score.
2	THIS WEEK	Identify 3–5 candidate technical co-founders with AI/ML background via IIT/NIT alumni networks.
3	THIS WEEK	Book 5 college placement cell meetings. Start with Tier-2 cities (Pune, Jaipur, Lucknow).
4	WEEK 2	Set up basic landing page with waitlist. Capture 500+ emails before beta launch.
5	WEEK 2	Conduct 20 user interviews (mix of students + fresh graduates). Document verbatim pain points.
6	WEEK 3	Launch WhatsApp community of 100+ target users as pre-product community validation.
7	WEEK 3	Build 3 employer relationships (startup founders, SME HRs) willing to post roles on beta.
8	WEEK 4	Ship closed beta. Measure 7-day retention, resume builds, NPS. Iterate weekly.
9	MONTH 2	Sign first 2 institutional MoUs. Use as proof for accelerator applications.
10	MONTH 2	Apply to YC W27, Surge, Antler India with traction data from beta cohort.

12 VALIDATION SCORES

Quantified assessment across four dimensions

87/100

Customer Clarity

ICP well-defined across 3 segments with distinct needs, behaviours, and WTP.

92/100

Problem Severity

Structural crisis: 57% unemployability, 13% graduate unemployment. Multiple independent data sources validate.

84/100

PMF Potential

Strong signal — freemium model + B2B2C anchor + no integrated incumbent. Risk: monetisation timing.

76/100

MVP Readiness

Clear scope. Technical co-founder gap is the primary readiness blocker. Community forming = positive signal.

Dimension	Weight	Score	Weighted
Problem Severity & Market Need	20%	9.0	1.80
Market Size & Growth (TAM/SAM)	15%	9.0	1.35
Founder-Market Fit	20%	7.7	1.54
Competitive Differentiation	15%	7.5	1.13
Business Model Viability	15%	7.5	1.13
Early Validation & Traction	10%	6.5	0.65
Execution Feasibility	5%	7.0	0.35
OVERALL VIABILITY SCORE	100%	—	8.3 / 10

■ FINAL VERDICT

STRONG DEMAND SIGNAL

You are building in the right market, at the right time, with the right motivation. India's graduate employability crisis is structural and growing — demand for your solution will not evaporate. Build the AI career path finder + resume builder as your Day-1 MVP. Ship in 90 days. Measure everything. Stay obsessively close to your users.

Primary conditions to sustain this GO verdict: (1) MVP live in 90 days with 500+ beta users · (2) 3 college MoUs signed · (3) Technical co-founder / AI lead identified before fundraising

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